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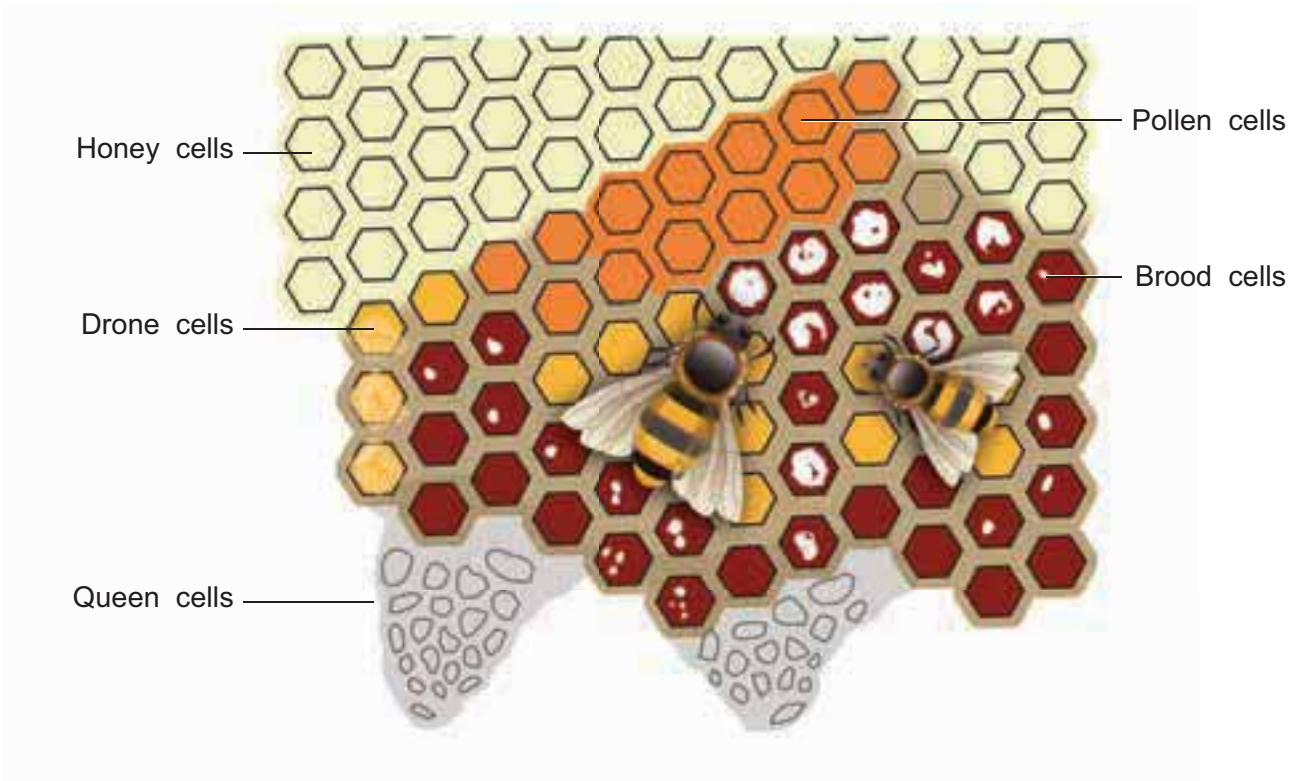


Figure 13.5 Structure of a hive showing various cells

are indigenous method and the modern method. In indigenous method, the honey extracted from the comb contains wax. To overcome the drawbacks of the indigenous method, the modern method has been developed to improve the texture of hives. In India, there are two types of beehives in practice namely, **Langstroth** and **Newton.** The Langstroth bee hive is made up of wood and consists of six parts (Figure 13.6) 1) **Stand** is the basal part of the hive on which the hive is constructed. The stands are adjusted to make a slope for rain water to drain 2) **Bottom board** is situated above the stand and forms the proper base for the hive. It has two gates, one gate functions as an entrance while the other acts as an exit. 3) **Brood chamber** is the most important part of the hive. It is provided with 5 to 10 frames arranged one above the other through which the workers can easily pass. The frame is composed of wax sheet which is held in vertical position up by a couple of wires. Every sheet of wax is known as Comb Foundation. The comb foundation helps in obtaining a regular strong worker brood cell comb which can be used repeatedly. 4) **Super** is also a chamber without cover and base. It is provided with many frames containing comb foundation to provide additional space for expansion of the hive. 5) **Inner cover** is a wooden piece used for covering the super with many holes for proper ventilation. 6) **Top cover** is meant for protecting the colonies from rains. It is covered with a sheet which is plain and sloping.

Besides the above primary equipments, other accessory equipments are used in beekeeping **Queen Excluder** is utilized to prevent the entry of queen